

INTERNVILLAGE

A signal that had gone quiet — and how we turned it back on

No funding. No tech stack. No active socials. Just a paused promise to help students find internships — and a decision not to let it stay paused.

ROLE

Growth & Outreach
Lead

DURATION

Sep 2023 — Dec
2024

REACH

1,000+ members · 70+
companies

FORMAT

Community & Outreach Case Study

— WHAT WE FOUND

We didn't launch this. We found it — sitting paused.

If something could help students, letting it stay dead felt like a waste.

WHAT CHANGED

Silent socials	→ Daily, human-toned posts
Scattered forwards	→ Labelled, categorised drops
No HR replies	→ 70+ companies engaged

- No fancy systems. **No active social handles.** No inbound messages from HRs.
- A community with members, but **no rhythm** — nothing posted, nothing curated, nothing followed up on.
- Just one vague, unfulfilled promise: **help students land internships.**

THE STARTING BRIEF

There were no resources, no roadmap, and no one asking us to do this. We rebuilt it anyway — with Google Sheets, cold DMs, and the belief that students deserved a version of this that actually worked.

— HOW WE REBUILT IT

Four parallel fixes, run at once

No single relaunch moment — just four broken parts repaired in parallel, each one feeding the others.

HR CONNECT**Honest outreach, not a pitch**

Personally messaged dozens of companies with notes that read like a person wrote them, not a platform. Plain asks, real follow-through — and it worked.

LISTING ACCURACY**Curated, not crawled**

Cut the fluff. Every internship was checked for relevance to what DU students actually wanted — remote, part-time, startup-friendly roles, not recycled listings.

INSTAGRAM**A voice, not a noticeboard**

Rewrote the tone from corporate-info-dump to something that read like a friend who actually understood the job hunt — informational, but human.

WHATSAPP**Structure over spam**

Replaced scattered forwards with labelled, categorised channels — clean listings, real-time updates, a rhythm students could actually rely on.

— WHERE IT LANDED

From a paused page to a 1,000-student fair

1,000+

Students placed or actively connected with opportunities

70+

Companies brought in to participate in the flagship Internship Fair

4.8 / 5

Average employer satisfaction rating from the fair

THE FAIR ITSELF

The Internship Fair was the proof point — companies and students in the same space, treated like they belonged there. Not a job board event; a room where both sides showed up prepared.

WHAT CARRIED IT

Micro-content — reels, real-time updates, peer shoutouts — kept the community warm between drops. A repeatable pipeline: daily listing intake, curation, then the funnel to students.

WHERE THE FUNNEL ACTUALLY RAN

Instagram

Top-of-funnel discovery — reels and listing drops in a conversational voice

WhatsApp

Daily structured listings — labelled, categorised, no spam

Direct HR Outreach

Personal messages to companies, tracked through to reply

Internship Fair

Closing the loop — 70+ companies and 1,000+ students, in person

MY ROLE

In the engine room, not on the stage

No title carried real weight here — the work did. I ran the parts that don't show up in a screenshot but decide whether a student trusts you the second time.

EXERCISED HERE

Cold outreach

Tone & voice

Workflow design

Stakeholder follow-up

- **Set the tone** for every piece of outward communication, so no student felt confused or talked down to.
- **Built the internal workflow** — from how listings entered the pipeline to how the brand stayed consistent across channels.
- **Ran the HR reachout core** — built outreach lists, tailored every ask, tracked replies, and kept the relationship feeling human, not transactional.
- **Owned the Instagram revival and listing drops** — refining what got posted, when, and how, week over week.

— WHAT IT TAUGHT ME

Three things that hold up now

01 Most students don't need a perfect platform. They need someone who gives a damn about whether their application gets seen.

02 Consistency beats strategy when you're starting from nothing — show up the same way, every week, before you optimise anything.

03 You don't need to own something to take responsibility for it. Community building is emotional infrastructure, and someone has to hold the weight.

None of this was glamorous. But it kept a dead signal answering — and that turned out to be the entire job.

— WITH WHAT I KNOW NOW

If I were rebuilding it today

Hindsight applied — the same scrappy instincts, with sharper tools behind them.

PORTAL

A Notion-based internship hub with real filters and tags, so students stop scrolling and start searching.

AUTOMATION

Airtable automation to update roles in real time instead of manual Sheet edits — same rigor, less drag.

HR OUTREACH

A storytelling-first approach to every HR post — leading with outcomes, not just open roles.

PROOF LOOP

A "Success Stories" reel series, closing the loop so students can see the outcomes, not just the process.

The instincts wouldn't change — show up consistently, write like a person, follow through. Only the tooling would catch up.

INTERNVILLAGE

A dead signal doesn't need a
relaunch.
It needs someone to **answer it.**

Gurdev
Thakur

Growth & Outreach Lead,
InternVillage

Sep 2023 — Dec
2024